

FILE 7 ON EDUCATION

Before you read the file, make sure you know / understand the following concepts

Linda McMahon
Bridget Phillipson
NEET
KIPPERS
State schools / public schools (UK)
Grammar schools (UK)
Charter schools (US)
Oxbridge
The Russel Group
Erasmus
Home fee status
The Turing Scheme
The Ivy League
Student loan debt

In groups, study the documents as follows:

Document 1 (Mines Ponts written exam)

- Why will the UK rejoin the Erasmus student scheme in 2027? (80 words, +/- 10%)
- What does international student mobility bring to countries? (180 words, +/- 10%)

Prepare Document 2 as an article for the Mines oral exam (LVA and / or LVB)

Documents 3, 4, 5 are for your information

Prepare Document 6 as an article for the Centrale oral exam (LVA and / or LVB)

Document 7: explain what a book ban is and give the arguments of the judge against the ban

Documents 8: translate the two texts

Iconographic documents: once you have described and analysed them, imagine a situation for a role play

<https://www.npr.org/2025/12/23/nx-s1-5630504/2026-federal-loans-student-changes-save-plan>

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xxXlWGPGjE>

UK will rejoin Erasmus student scheme in 2027

www.bbc.com, December 17, 2025 (abridged)

The UK will rejoin the Erasmus study scheme from 2027, six years after announcing it would end its participation as part of a deal to leave the European Union (EU).

Britons will be able to spend a year studying at European universities as part of their UK degree courses without paying extra fees, and vice versa for European students.

Under the new deal, the UK will pay £570m to join an expanded Erasmus + scheme in 2027, which the government said represented a 30% discount.

Minister Nick Thomas-Symonds said the agreement proved the government's "new partnership with the EU is working", but Conservative shadow foreign secretary Priti Patel said the deal was a "betrayal" of Brexit. [...]

It enables students to study abroad at partner universities and higher education organisations by offering grants to help with living costs.

Participating students usually pay fees to their home institutions, with additional costs covered by the European Union, funded by taxpayers' money.

Britain could have remained a member of Erasmus after Brexit, but then prime minister Boris Johnson said the programme did not offer value for money.

The UK argued that before Brexit more than twice as many EU students came to the UK as British students travelled to Europe at a net cost to the UK taxpayer.

In 2020, the last year in which the UK participated in Erasmus, the scheme received €144m (£126m) of EU funding for 55,700 people to take part in Erasmus projects overall. [...]

Ministers who introduced the Turing scheme in 2021 said it was designed to benefit more people from disadvantaged backgrounds and provide greater support for travel costs than the Erasmus scheme did.

While the cost of the new deal is roughly four times what the UK paid the last time it accessed the Erasmus scheme, it is not a like-for-like comparison.

The government is pointing out that under the Brexit deal the default price for rejoining the scheme - based on the UK's GDP - was set at £810m a year, but negotiated down.

Since Brexit, the Erasmus + has expanded, doubling its budget and pushing for greater uptake from among schools, adult learning and sports courses.

The government argues more than 100,000 people in the UK could benefit.

Supporters claimed Erasmus boosted the UK economy even after taking into account membership costs, and helped support universities financially.

Prime Minister Sir Keir Starmer reopened talks in May, claiming that a youth mobility scheme could also be part of a new deal with the EU.

Alex Stanley, from the National Union of Students (NUS), said it was "fantastic that another generation of students will be able to be part of the Erasmus programme", adding that it would represent a "huge win for the student movement". [...]

Nell Eustace, a student from Bristol currently studying in Italy, welcomed the UK rejoining Erasmus + as the Turing scheme "has been much less reliable".

"The government did not give my university enough money to cover all students this academic year, so only students from under-represented backgrounds received funding," she said.

"I am relieved that the Erasmus scheme will be available to future students... but it does highlight how Brexit has affected those who weren't even old enough to have a say at the time it was voted for." [...]

Number of UK students reporting mental health difficulties triples

www.timeshighereducation.com, February 20, 2025

The number of UK undergraduate students reporting mental health conditions has tripled in seven years, with hopes that things were improving among certain badly affected groups proving to be a false dawn.

An estimated 300,000 students could now be experiencing mental health struggles in the UK, according to Transforming Access to Student Outcomes in Higher Education (TASO) and the Policy Institute at King's College London, whose joint report highlights that almost one-fifth (18 per cent) of students reported a mental health issue in 2024.

This is triple what it was in 2017, when about 6 per cent of students reported mental health challenges. Rates are now at their highest levels since records began, and the report says that “while the Covid-19 pandemic is often considered to have contributed to this, it does not explain the ongoing rise in mental health difficulties”.

It adds that “even allowing for changing definitions and an increasing openness about mental health”, the findings suggest that “many thousands of students are experiencing substantial distress and that this number has risen dramatically in recent years”.

“The trend pre-dates the Covid-19 pandemic and the cost-of-living crisis. Although these factors play a part in students’ deteriorating mental health, they cannot therefore be the only explanation.”

The report, which draws on data collected for the latest Student Academic Experience Survey that polled 93,212 students, found there were significant disparities between demographic groups, with women being twice as likely to report mental health difficulties (22 per cent) compared with men (11 per cent).

Overall, students who identify as LGBTQ experienced by far the highest rates of mental health challenges. This has dashed hopes that mental health among LGBTQ students might be improving – which was “one of the few positive stories” to come out of the previous report, when it was identified that mental health rates among these students had declined.

Some 42 per cent of bisexual and lesbian students said they faced mental health challenges, compared with 35 per cent of bisexual students who said they did last year, and 32 per cent of lesbian students.

Mental health difficulties among lesbian women and gay men rose at approximately three times the rate of straight people, and among bisexual and asexual people at roughly twice the rate.

Meanwhile, the number of trans students who reported mental health conditions jumped from 25 per cent in 2023 to 40 per cent in 2024.

Michael Sanders, TASO’s academic lead and professor of public policy at King’s College London, said LGBTQ students and women “bear the brunt of this rise” in declining mental health, and “urgent action is needed to understand and address these trends”.

Omar Khan, chief executive at TASO, added that the findings showed “we need a comprehensive response from the sector and wider society, involving a ‘public health approach’ to student mental health, and to mental health generally”.

He added that services – whether well-being or clinical – “need to be clearly signposted to students, and available for those who are most at risk of mental health difficulties – especially LGTBQ+ students, women, and those from state schools”.

‘I received a first but it felt tainted and undeserved’: inside the university AI cheating crisis

The Guardian, December 15, 2024 (abridged)

The email arrived out of the blue: it was the university code of conduct team. Albert, a 19-year-old undergraduate English student, scanned the content, stunned. He had been accused of using artificial intelligence to complete a piece of assessed work. If he did not attend a hearing to address the claims made by his professor, or respond to the email, he would receive an automatic fail on the module. The problem was, he hadn't cheated.

Albert, who asked to remain anonymous, was distraught. It might not have been his best effort, but he'd worked hard on the essay. He certainly didn't use AI to write it: "And to be accused of it because of 'signpost phrases', such as 'in addition to' and 'in contrast', felt very demeaning." [...] "I had studied hard and was generally a straight-A student – one bad essay suddenly meant I used AI?" [...]

Two years have passed since ChatGPT was released into the world. It has shaken industries from film to media to medicine, and education is no different. Created by San Francisco-based OpenAI, it makes it possible for almost anyone to produce passable written work in seconds based on a few basic inputs. Many such tools are now available, such as Google's Gemini, Microsoft Copilot, Claude and Perplexity. These large language models absorb and process vast datasets, much like a human brain, in order to generate new material. For students, it's as close as you can get to a fairy godmother for a last-minute essay deadline. For educators, however, it's a nightmare.

More than half of students now use generative AI to help with their assessments, according to a survey by the Higher Education Policy Institute, and about 5% of students admit using it to cheat. In November, *Times Higher Education* reported that, despite "patchy record keeping", cases appeared to be soaring at Russell Group universities, some of which had reported a 15-fold increase in cheating. But confusion over how these tools should be used – if at all – has sown suspicion in

institutions designed to be built on trust. Some believe that AI stands to revolutionise how people learn for the better, like a 24/7 personal tutor – Professor HAL, if you like. To others, it is an existential threat to the entire system of learning – a "plague upon education" as one op-ed for *Inside Higher Ed* put it – that stands to demolish the process of academic inquiry.

In the struggle to stuff the genie back in the bottle, universities have become locked in an escalating technological arms race, even turning to AI themselves to try to catch misconduct. Tutors are turning on students, students on each other and hardworking learners are being caught by the flak. It's left many feeling pessimistic about the future of higher education. But is ChatGPT really the problem universities need to grapple with? Or is it something deeper?

Albert is not the only student to find himself wrongly accused of using AI. For many years, the main tool in the academy's anti-cheating arsenal has been software, such as Turnitin, which scans submissions for signs of plagiarism. In 2023, Turnitin launched a new AI detection tool that assesses the proportion of the text that is likely to have been written by AI.

Amid the rush to counteract a surge in AI-written assignments, it seemed like a magic bullet. Since then, Turnitin has processed more than 130m papers and says it has flagged 3.5m as being 80% AI-written. But it is also not 100% reliable; there have been widely reported cases of false positives and some universities have chosen to opt out. Turnitin says the rate of error is below 1%, but considering the size of the student population, it is no wonder that many have found themselves in the line of fire.

There is also evidence that suggests AI detection tools disadvantage certain demographics. One study at Stanford found that a number of AI detectors have a bias towards non-English speakers, flagging their work 61% of the time, as opposed to 5% of native English speakers (Turnitin was not part of this particular study). [...]

Home schooling surge threatens social skills, says Ofsted boss

The Times, January 10, 2026 (abridged)

Too many children are being home schooled in England out of “desperation” because parents feel there is no alternative, according to the head of Ofsted.

While countries such as Germany, Greece, the Netherlands and Sweden ban home schooling, the UK has some of the most relaxed regulations in Europe.

Any parent can decide to home school their child as long as they are giving them “a full-time education from the age of five”. Parents do not have to follow the national curriculum, and there is no requirement to register a child as home schooled with a local authority.

In England, the main reasons cited by parents are the child’s mental health (14 per cent), philosophical reasons (14 per cent) and lifestyle (9 per cent). Dissatisfaction with schools, be it because of bullying or special needs provision, make up 13 per cent, according to government data.

While many parents do a brilliant job home schooling their children, others use Britain’s lax rules as a way of taking their children out of the system, but provide little education. The child can easily become isolated from their peer group unless an effort is made to socialise with their age group.

The Children’s Wellbeing and Schools Bill, which is at the report stage in the House of Lords, will create a national register for home-schooled children. Parents of those subject to child protection inquiries and plans will need local authority permission to withdraw their children from school. [...]

In 2024-25, 111,700 children in England were officially home schooled, up from 80,900 in 2022-23, an increase of 38 per cent. The numbers are believed to be an underestimate because home schooling does not have to be registered. This will change under the Children’s Wellbeing and Schools Bill.

However, England will remain one of the most liberal countries in Europe for home education. In Portugal, for example, a parent teaching

their child needs to have a university degree. Since 2022, home schooling in France has been severely restricted because of concerns that children were falling under the influence of “Islamist extremism”. There are only a few exceptions to the rule, including for elite athletes and those with serious health conditions.

Oliver said there were “multiple reasons” why parents decided to home school, adding: “[It’s] because of a curriculum gap, because of a behaviour gap, because of an attendance gap. There are too many parents who are finding that the system isn’t working for them and are withdrawing their child from the school system, not by choice but by desperation.” [...]

From Monday, Ofsted will begin publishing new inspection report cards for schools. Rather than giving schools a single one-word judgment such as “good” or “outstanding”, they will score six core categories such as attendance and behaviour; achievement; personal development and wellbeing, and inclusion. The scores will range from “exceptional” to needing “urgent improvement”. There will be no overall judgment.

The inclusion category will look at how well schools are meeting the needs of all children, including what adjustments they make to help keep pupils in school.

Oliver said they would look closely at schools in areas with high numbers of home schooled children and those “missing in education” entirely, which refers to children of school age who are not registered at a school or for home schooling. They are registered with the NHS when they are born, but then either never go to school, or were excluded from school and never went to a new one.

On top of the 112,000 children who are home schooled, Ofsted estimates a further 39,000 are “missing in education” and 41,000 are on part-time timetables, when they only go into school for shorter hours or fewer days. For example, some are gradually reintegrated after illness or a period of absenteeism.

Last month Ofsted’s annual report raised concerns about children “with unorthodox patterns of education, such as flexi-schooling and part-time timetables”. About 166,000 children are severely absent and miss more than half of school days, three times the level before the pandemic.

Harvard beat Trump in court. Here's what could happen next.

The Washington Post, September 5, 2025

A federal judge's ruling Wednesday was a resounding win for Harvard — a sweeping finding that the Trump administration had violated the Constitution in freezing federal research funding to the school. It was immediately cheered by faculty, alumni and student groups, with many urging Harvard to keep fighting.

But despite the victory, Harvard faces daunting hurdles in its standoff against an administration determined to force change on higher education, and the final outcome for the nation's oldest university is far from clear.

The challenges are unprecedented: They include a promised appeal in court, worry that the government will slow-walk restoring frozen research funds, threats to future grants, complicated settlement negotiations — and the prospect of another 3½ years of a hostile White House with a bevy of arrows in its quiver and a proven willingness to aim them at its opponents.

The Trump administration, which has already opened numerous investigations at Harvard, has threatened to revoke its nonprofit status and to bar international students and scholars from campus.

On Thursday it signaled new plans to eventually “streamline” the process of denying funding for schools found to have violated civil rights law. [...]

The White House made clear the fight is by no means over.

“Harvard does not have a constitutional right to taxpayer dollars,” spokeswoman Liz Huston said, “and remains ineligible for grants in the future.”

On Wednesday, U.S. District Judge Allison D. Burroughs ruled that freezing more than \$2 billion in research grants and other federal actions violated Harvard's right to freedom of speech and federal laws. She vacated the freeze and barred the Trump administration from using similar reasoning to block grants to Harvard in the future. In a strongly worded ruling, she said the government “used antisemitism as a smoke

screen for a targeted, ideologically-motivated assault on this country's premier universities,” jeopardizing decades of research.

The White House said it will appeal the ruling, and many expect the case to advance to the Supreme Court.

Experts said the Trump administration's first move could be to ask that Wednesday's order be paused pending the outcome of an appeal, which would allow the government to delay resuming any payments to Harvard. That request would be considered by both Burroughs and the U.S. Court of Appeals for the 1st Circuit, said David Super, a law professor at Georgetown University.

If Burroughs's order is not stayed, then the government is likely to take the same request to the Supreme Court for immediate relief via what is known as the “emergency docket.”

Wednesday's ruling was “nearly a complete victory” for Harvard, said Michael Gerhardt, a law professor at the University of North Carolina. As a result, the Trump administration's goal will be to get its arguments before the Supreme Court — where it expects a favorable hearing — “as soon as possible,” Gerhardt said. [...]

Noah Feldman, a law professor at Harvard, said parts of Burroughs's ruling appeared tailored to address guidance provided by Justice Amy Coney Barrett, who proved a key swing vote in an August ruling in a somewhat similar case. Wednesday's order is a “masterful piece of technical legal craftsmanship,” Feldman said.

A full appeal of Burroughs's ruling would probably take months. Super predicted that there could be an appellate court decision in the case by Thanksgiving, which would allow for a Supreme Court hearing in the spring.

This wouldn't be the first case about federal funding cuts to make it to the Supreme Court this year. [...]

Even if higher courts affirm that Harvard's funding must be restored, there are ways for the administration to drag its feet.

The grant funding does not automatically resume. Rather, someone in the government needs to reauthorize payments and reactivate grants, said Scott Delaney, a research scientist at Harvard's T.H. Chan School of Public Health.

How student loans and financial aid are changing in 2026

The Washington Post, January 2, 2026 (abridged)

[...] In one of the largest revisions to federal student loan policy in decades, the Education Department will impose new caps on the amount of money graduate students and parents can borrow from the government.

The Grad Plus program, which lets students borrow up to the full cost of attendance to pay for graduate degrees, will sunset on July 1 for new borrowers. At the same time, people pursuing a master's degree will have their borrowing capped at \$20,500 a year and \$100,000 over a lifetime. Those working toward a professional degree — say, an aspiring doctor or lawyer — will be capped at \$50,000 a year and \$200,000 in total from the federal government.

In all, students will now face a lifetime maximum borrowing limit of \$257,500 for undergraduate and graduate school federal loans combined. If those amounts are not enough to cover costs, students will have to pay the rest themselves or turn to private lenders.

The distinction between graduate and professional degree programs has been a lightning rod for controversy. Nurses and others have railed against the Education Department's proposal to exclude their fields from the higher loan limits. They worry that the agency's move to restrict the professional degree classification to 11 fields will discourage people from enrolling in other advanced degree programs.

The proposal must still be published for public comment before it can be finalized, which allows its detractors to fight for a broader classification.

Researchers say a substantial number of students pursuing master's degrees will be affected by the new limits. An analysis by the Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia found that one-third of graduate students with federal loans have borrowed more than the new limits will allow. Research from the Postsecondary Education & Economics Research Center at American University found that students in professional programs are more likely to borrow in excess of the new limit.

Beth Akers, a senior fellow at the conservative American Enterprise Institute, said she suspects that many people will be caught off guard by the new constraints on graduate borrowing, and she says colleges are not doing enough to prepare.

"There could be a private-sector solution that covers the gap," Akers said. "But I suspect that the coordination that's necessary for that to happen by next fall will probably not happen."

There have been a lot of conversations among schools about offering institutional loans to help graduate students in need, said Scott Z. Goldschmidt, a partner at the law firm Thompson Coburn who works with higher-education clients. He said colleges are also exploring private loan alternatives and trying to identify scholarship opportunities. [...]

Current borrowers are exempt from both of the new caps for three years.

The federal student loan repayment system is notoriously complex, with a multitude of options and terms that can be difficult to navigate. Instead of having seven repayment plans, new borrowers will have just two options after July 1: one standard plan and one new income-driven repayment (IDR) plan, called the Repayment Assistance Plan (RAP).

The new standard plan will stretch monthly payments out from 10 to 25 years. The larger the debt, the longer the repayment term. Someone with an outstanding principal of less than \$25,000 will repay the debt for no more than 10 years, while a borrower with more than \$100,000 in federal loans will be in repayment for up to 25 years. [...]

Federal judge overturns part of Florida's book ban law, drawing on nearly 100 years of precedent protecting First Amendment access to ideas

www.theconversation.com, September 17, 2025 (abridged)

When a junior at an Orange County public high school in Florida visited the school library to check out a copy of “On the Road” by Jack Kerouac, it wasn’t in its Dewey decimal system-assigned location.

It turns out the title had been removed from the library’s shelves because of a complaint, and in compliance with Florida House Bill 1069, it had been removed from the library indefinitely. Kerouac’s quintessential chronicle of the Beat Generation in the 1950s, along with hundreds of other titles, was not available for students to read.

Gov. Ron DeSantis signed the bill into law in July 2023. Under this law, if a parent or community member objected to a book on the grounds that it was obscene or pornographic, the school had to remove that title from the curriculum within five days and hold a public hearing with a special magistrate appointed by the state.

On Aug. 13, 2025, Judge Carlos Mendoza of the U.S. Middle District of Florida ruled in *Penguin Random House v. Gibson* that parts of Florida HB 1069 are unconstitutional and violate students’ First Amendment right of free access to ideas.

The plaintiffs who filed the suit included the five largest trade book publishing houses, a group of award-winning authors, the Authors Guild, which is a labor union for published professional authors with over 15,000 members, and the parents of a group of Florida students.

Though the state filed an appeal on Sept. 11, 2025, this is an important ruling on censorship in a time when many states are passing or debating similar laws. [...]

In his ruling in August 2025, Mendoza pointed out that many of the removed books are classics with no sexual content at all. This was made possible in part by the formulation of HB 1069. The law allows anyone from the community to challenge a book simply by filling out a form, at which point the school is mandated to remove that book within five days.

In order to put a book back in circulation, however, the law requires a hearing to be held by the state’s appointed magistrate, and there is no specified deadline by which this hearing must take place.

Mendoza did not strike down the parts of HB 1069 that require school districts to follow a state policy for challenging books. In line with precedent, he also left in place challenges for obscenity using the Miller test and with reference to age-appropriateness for mature content.

The Florida Department of Education argued that HB 1069 is protected by Florida’s First Amendment right of government speech, a legal theory that the government has the right to prevent any opposing views to its own in schools or any government platform. Mendoza questioned this argument, suggesting that “slapping the label of government speech on book removals only serves to stifle the disfavored viewpoints.”

In the wake of Mendoza’s decision, Florida schools are unlikely to pull more books from the shelves, but they are also unlikely to immediately return them. Some school librarians have said that they are awaiting the outcome of the appeal before taking action.

States with similar laws on the books or in the works will also be watching the appeal.

Some of these laws in other states have also been challenged, with mixed outcomes. The U.S. Court of Appeals for the 5th Circuit already struck down Texas’ appeal of a ruling against Texas House Bill 900. And parts of an Iowa bill currently are being challenged in court.

But the NAACP’s lawsuit against South Carolina Regulation 43-170 was dismissed On Sept. 8, 2025. And Utah’s House Bill 29 has not yet faced a challenge in court, though it could be affected by the outcomes of these lawsuits in other states.

[La série *Adolescence* sera diffusée dans les écoles britanniques pour sensibiliser aux dangers des réseaux sociaux]

Après un succès unanime sur Netflix, la série *Adolescence* s'apprête à rencontrer un autre genre de succès... dans les salles de classe. Le gouvernement britannique a décidé de diffuser cette fiction coup-de-poing dans les établissements scolaires, espérant ainsi ouvrir les yeux des élèves sur les dangers insidieux des réseaux sociaux.

Le gouvernement britannique souhaite donc initier un dialogue là où les brochures de prévention semblent échouer depuis des années. Le premier ministre, Keir Starmer, a déclaré avoir lui-même vu *Adolescence* avec ses deux enfants, apportant son soutien à « une initiative importante pour encourager le plus grand nombre possible d'élèves à regarder ce programme ». La démarche est également saluée par les associations qui luttent pour la protection de l'enfance. Maria Neophytou, directrice de la NSPCC estime que l'éducation joue un rôle majeur dans ce combat et donc que la diffusion de ce programme en particulier dans les écoles est nécessaire. « Nous ne pouvons pas attendre des professeurs et des parents qu'ils fassent tout le travail. (...) Les entreprises de la tech doivent faire du bien-être des enfants une priorité » et « il est de leur responsabilité de s'assurer que leurs plateformes et sites sont conçus pour être sûrs pour les jeunes utilisateurs », souligne-t-elle.

www.vanityfair.fr, 2 avril 2025 (adapté)

Le plus clair de la vie d'Adrian s'est passé à faire des probabilités et, de temps à autre, à écouter Bach et les Beach Boys. Il n'a pas construit de famille, aucun enfant ne porte son nom, à moins de promouvoir au rang de progéniture un obscur théorème. Meredith est sa première émotion amoureuse depuis fort longtemps, et en l'instant, il se dit même : depuis toujours. (...)

- J'ai bu, dit-il d'emblée. (...) Et je pue la bière, pardon.

- Je ne saurais trop vous dire, Adrian, car moi aussi. C'est le parfum de la contrariété et de l'ennui.

Car Meredith s'ennuie à Princeton. La Londonnienne n'aime pas cette ville de province, (...) ce campus qui tente de ressembler à Poudlard avec ses donjons et ses beffrois moyenâgeux du dix-neuvième, elle ne s'habitue pas à ces étudiants qui se croient sortis tout droit de la cuisse de Jupiter et qui, sous prétexte que leurs parents ont déboursé soixante mille dollars de frais de scolarité, lui mailent à toute heure des questions triviales sur le théorème de non-plongement de Gromov, questions auxquelles ils exigent une réponse immédiate (...)

Hervé Le Tellier, *L'Anomalie*, 2020

